Website audit · ne-arc.org

A strong mission, too many doors. Making ne-arc.org work for families, donors and parcels.

A review of the Northeast Arc homepage and its key journeys: getting support, donating, and shopping at parcels, on desktop and mobile.

UX score

58 /100

Needs work

Clarity of paths	52
Donation journey	44
Mobile experience	50
Content and trust	72
Performance and accessibility	60

Website	Pages reviewed	Devices	Prepared by
ne-arc.org	Homepage, Donate, parcels page, mobile	Desktop + mobile	AR Tanveer, Cognixlab

How to read this report

Problem what is costing you · Action what to change

Gain expected result · Key fact number or detail to notice

Severity Critical · High · Medium · Low

Orange boxes on screenshots mark the problem area

01 · Summary

The site explains who Northeast Arc is. It does not tell each visitor what to do next.

Northeast Arc serves three very different audiences from one homepage: families looking for help, donors and supporters, and job seekers. Today they all meet a nine slide carousel, a long services grid and a footer full of links. **On phones the Donate button disappears entirely until the footer**. parcels, the organisation's own social enterprise, **is slide five of nine**. The recommendations below give each audience a clear path and use the homepage's traffic to **lift parcels sales**.

2	4	3	2 to 3x
Critical issues blocking sales or goals	High priority issues	Medium and low polish issues	Estimated increase in visitors sent to the parcels store

The core problem

There is **no single primary action.** Nine rotating slides compete for attention, so families, donors and shoppers all have to hunt.

The biggest lever

On mobile, **Donate is hidden** in the menu and only visible in the footer, about 7,100px down the page.

The parcels link

The homepage reaches far more people than the store. A **permanent parcels module** would turn existing supporters into gift buyers.

02 · Strengths

What is already working

These are worth protecting in any redesign.

+ Human, credible story

Founded by parents in 1954, the origin story is moving and well written, and photos show real people served.

+ Social proof

Awards (Top Workplace, Top Women-Led Businesses) and partner logos (Cummings, BCBS Foundation, ECCF) build trust.

+ Clear intake contact

A referral email and phone number sit right above the services, so families have a direct line.

+ Accessibility intent

An accessibility widget and a language switcher are present on every page.

+ Well described services

Seven service areas each have a short, plain language summary and a Learn more link.

+ Strong impact numbers

10,000+ people, 190+ communities and 1,100+ employees are memorable proof of scale.

03 · Findings

Issues, evidence and fixes

Each finding shows the live screen we captured, the problem marked in orange, what to change, and the result you can expect. Ordered by business impact.

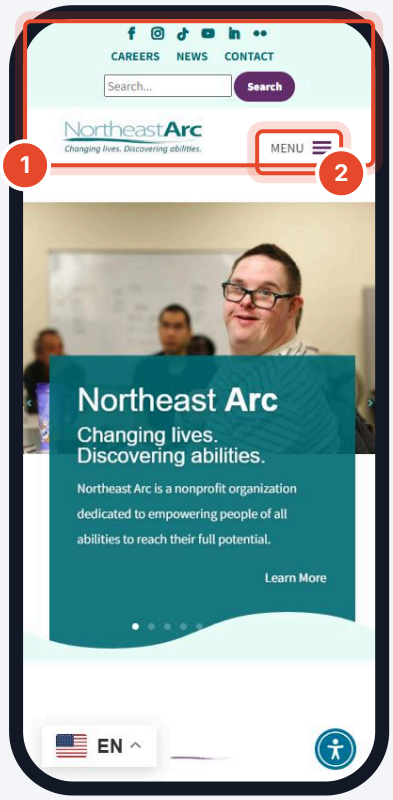
01	On mobile, the Donate button is hidden until the footer, about 7,100px down	Critical
02	A nine slide auto carousel replaces a clear headline and primary action	Critical
03	parcels, the organisation's own store, is buried as slide 5 of 9 and a third level menu item	High
04	The donation page has no story, no impact framing and no "why give now"	High

05	Families looking for help must decode service names; there is no "Get support" path	High
06	Mobile first screen: utility bar and a blank caption area push content down	Medium
07	Footer headings collide and text breaks mid word	Medium
08	"Join our mailing list" sends people to another page instead of capturing the email	Medium
09	A heavy homepage, and inner pages that refused our test browser	High

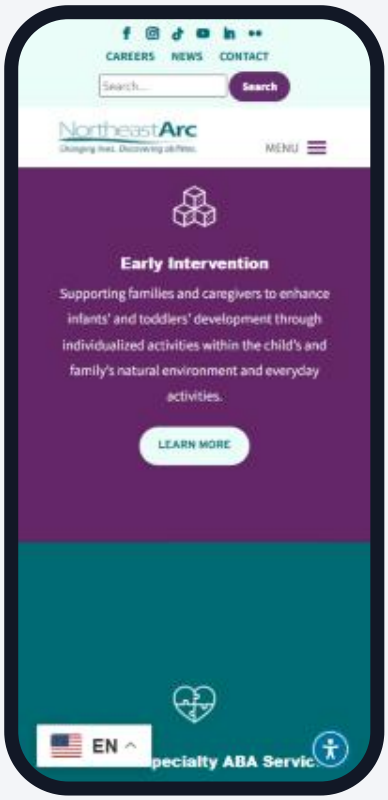
Finding 01

Critical | Donation | Effort: S

On mobile, the Donate button is hidden until the footer, about 7,100px down



Mobile header: social icons and search, no Donate



Seven full width service tiles before the footer

Why it costs you

Most nonprofit website traffic now comes from phones, often from social posts. If supporters cannot see how to give within a thumb's reach, many will not open a menu to look for it.

What we found

- On desktop, Donate is a clear purple button in the header. On a 375px phone it is **folded into the MENU**.
- The first Donate link visible without opening the menu is in the footer, **about 7,100px down a 7,850px page**.
- **The top 160px** of the phone screen is used by social icons, Careers, News, Contact and a search box.

Recommendation

→ Keep a **Donate** button visible in the mobile header next to MENU, or add a slim sticky "Donate" bar at the bottom.

→ **Move social icons and search into the menu** on mobile to give the first screen back to content.

→ Use the same purple button style everywhere so Donate is instantly recognisable.

Expected impact if fixed

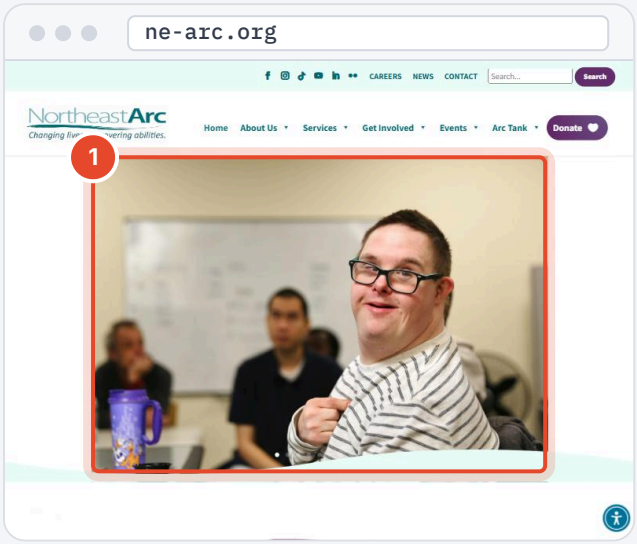
+40 to 80%
mobile visits to the donation page

+15 to 25%
online gifts from mobile

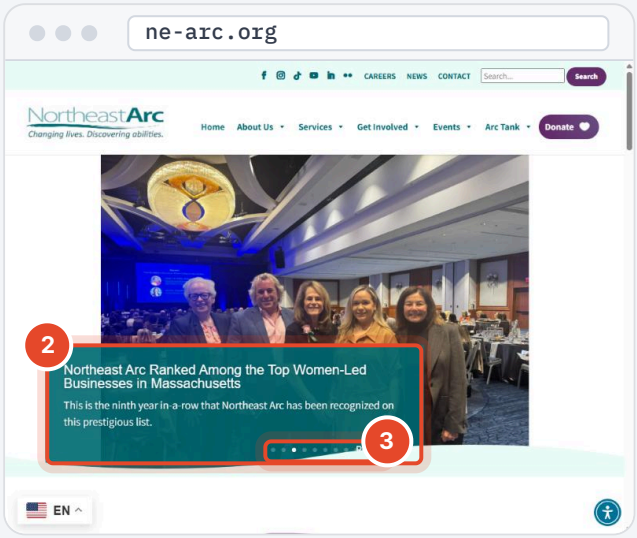
Finding 02

Critical | Homepage | Effort: M

A nine slide auto carousel replaces a clear headline and primary action



First slide on load: a photo with no message or button



Caption box covers the slide dots and clips "Read more"

Why it costs you

Carousels spread attention thin; most visitors only ever see the first slide. When that slide carries no message, the homepage's most valuable space says nothing.

What we found

- The hero **rotates nine slides**: awards, jobs, parcels, legacy giving, a playground, mental health training and more.
- On load, the first slide shows a photo with **no headline or button for several seconds**; on mobile the caption area is blank white.
- The caption panel overlaps the slide indicators, and the "Read more" link is **cut off by the decorative wave**.

Recommendation

→ Replace the carousel with a **static hero**: "Lifelong support for people with disabilities and autism" plus three buttons: **Get support, Donate, Shop parcels**.

→ Move news, awards and events into a "What's happening" row of three cards below.

→ If a carousel stays, stop autoplay, show the caption on load and keep controls clear of the text.

Expected impact if fixed

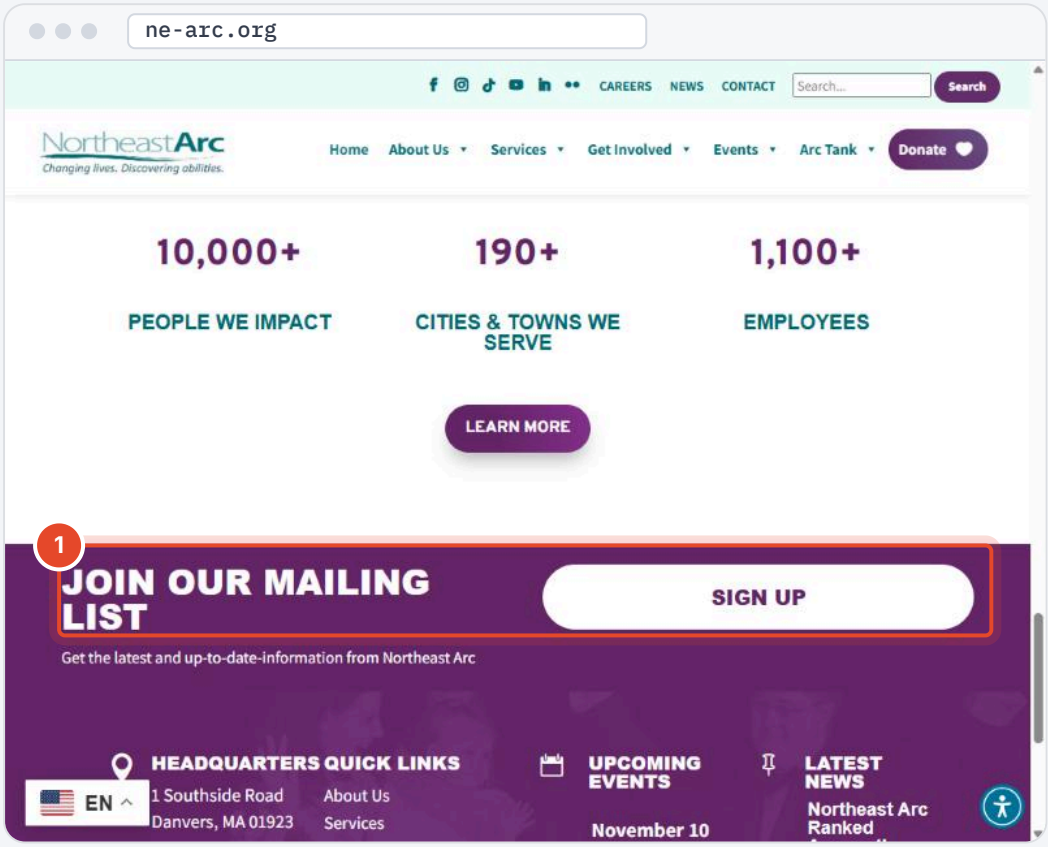
+20 to 40%
clicks from the homepage to key pages

-10 to 20%
homepage bounce rate

Finding 03

High | parcels | Effort: S

parcels, the organisation's own store, is buried as slide 5 of 9 and a third level menu item



The homepage ends without any shop or gift module

Why it costs you

ne-arc.org reaches families, staff, donors and partners who already care about the mission, the warmest possible audience for parcels. Today almost none of that attention is passed to the store.

What we found

- The only homepage path to parcels is **the fifth carousel slide** ("Visit parcels at the Liberty Tree Mall") and About Us > Innovative Businesses > parcels.
- The parcels page on ne-arc.org then links out with one "Shop Online Now" button.
- There is no product, gift guide or holiday shopping message **anywhere on the homepage in November**.

Recommendation

→ Add a permanent **"Shop with purpose"** band on the homepage with 4 featured products pulled from parcelsgifts.com and a "Shop holiday gifts" button.

→ Add **Shop parcels** as a top level menu item (with an external link icon).

→ Promote parcels in the mailing list and on the Thank you page after a donation.

Expected impact if fixed

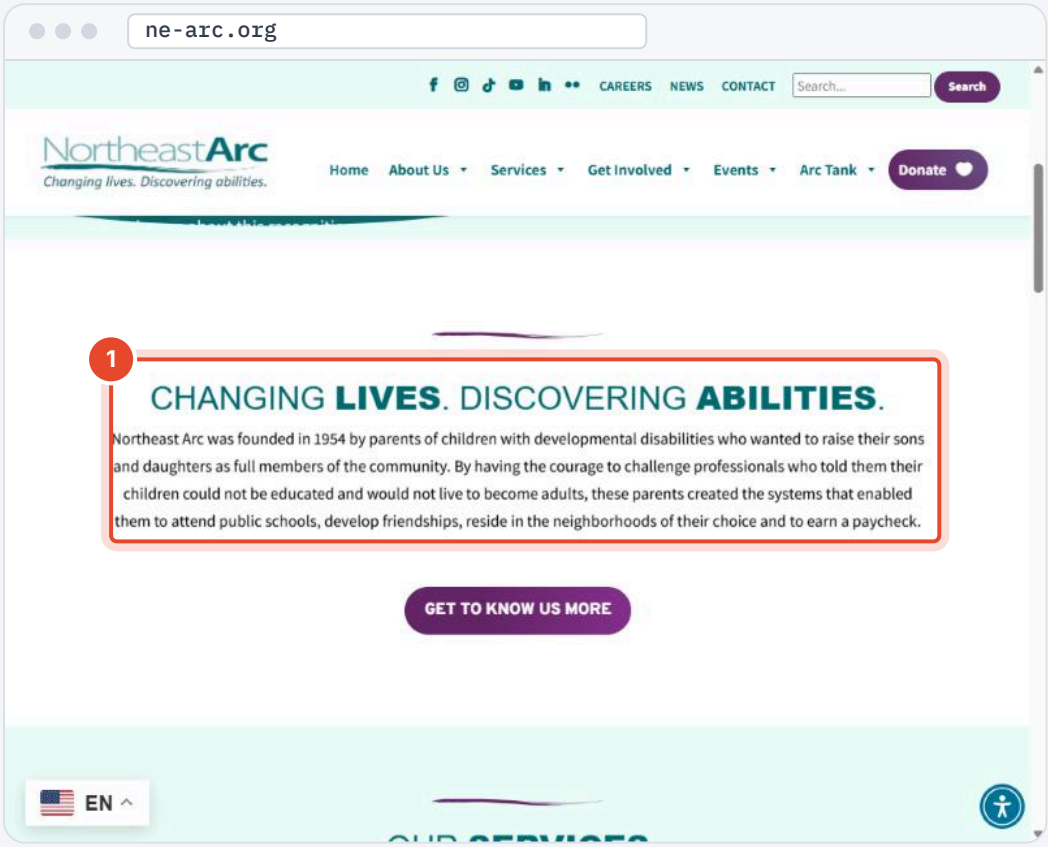
2 to 3x
referral visits to parcelsgifts.com

+10 to 20%
parcels online orders from ne-arc.org visitors

Finding 04

High | Donation | Effort: M

The donation page has no story, no impact framing and no "why give now"



The emotive copy lives on the homepage, not on the donation page

Why it costs you

Donors give to outcomes, not to forms. A short story and concrete impact amounts typically raise both completion rate and average gift.

What we found

- Apart from the embedded donation form, **the page copy is a single link**: "Click Here For More Ways To Give".
- **No headline, photo, impact examples** ("$50 funds..."), monthly giving prompt or tax deductible note in the page content.
- Header Donate and footer Donate **point to different pages** (/donate-online-to-northeast-arc/ vs /get-involved/donate/).

Recommendation

→ Add a headline and photo above the form, plus 3 impact tiers: **$50, $150, $500** with what each achieves.

→ Default to **monthly giving** with a one time option; add "Your gift is tax deductible" and a charity rating badge if available.

→ Point every Donate link to the same page and add a parcels gift suggestion on the Thank you screen.

Expected impact if fixed

+10 to 25%
donation form completion

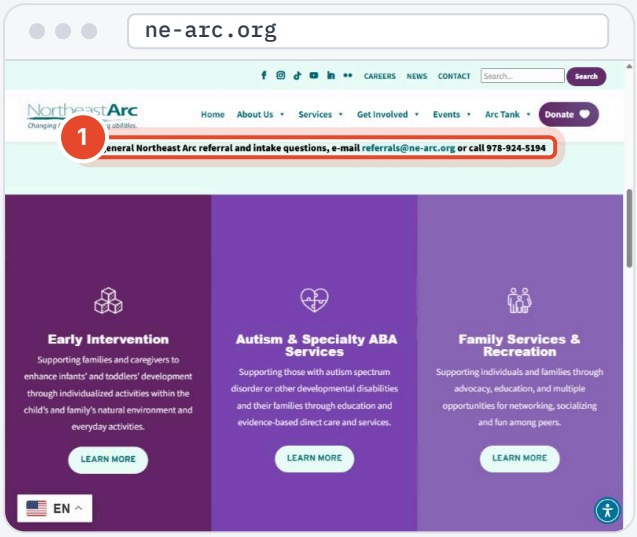
+15 to 20%
average online gift

+
share of recurring donors

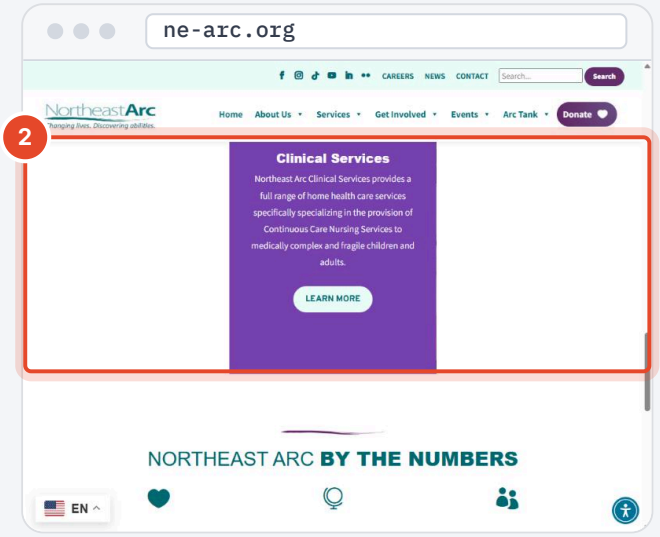
Finding 05

High | Navigation | Effort: M

Families looking for help must decode service names; there is no "Get support" path



Intake details are one line of small text above the grid



Seven tiles in a three column grid leave one orphan tile

Why it costs you

A parent arriving after a diagnosis is often stressed and unfamiliar with the jargon. Guiding them by age or need shortens the path to an intake call.

What we found

- Help seekers must know terms such as "Day Habilitation", "Specialty ABA" or "LTSS" to find the right service.
- The referral email and phone appear as one line of text, easy to miss.
- The services grid has 7 tiles in 3 columns, leaving Clinical Services alone with empty space on both sides; the grid is also coded twice (once per screen size), so screen readers hear every heading twice.

Recommendation

→ Add a "Find support for..." selector: Infant or toddler, School age child, Adult, Family or caregiver.

→ Turn the intake line into a prominent card with a "Request a call back" form.

→ Rebalance the grid (4 + 4 with a "Find support" tile) and remove the duplicate markup.

Expected impact if fixed

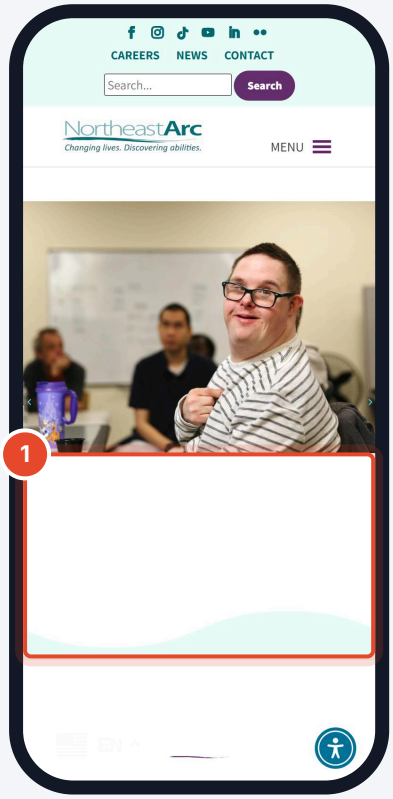
+15 to 30%
intake enquiries from the website

Faster
time to first contact for families

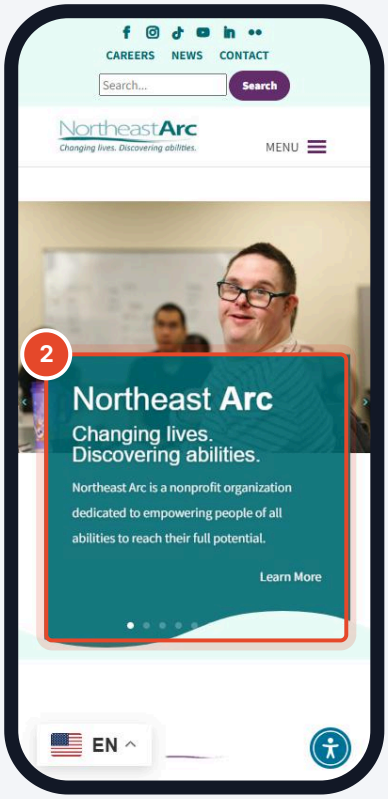
Finding 06

Medium | Mobile | Effort: S

Mobile first screen: utility bar and a blank caption area push content down



On load, a large blank area sits under the photo



After a few seconds the caption appears

Why it costs you

Blank space during load looks broken, and very long pages hide the footer contact details and Donate link.

What we found

- On first load the space below the hero photo is **blank white until the slider script runs**.
- The page is **about 7,850px tall on a phone**, with services stacked as seven full screen tiles.

Recommendation

→ **Render the caption in HTML on load** instead of waiting for the slider script.

→ Show services as a compact two column icon grid on mobile.

Expected impact if fixed

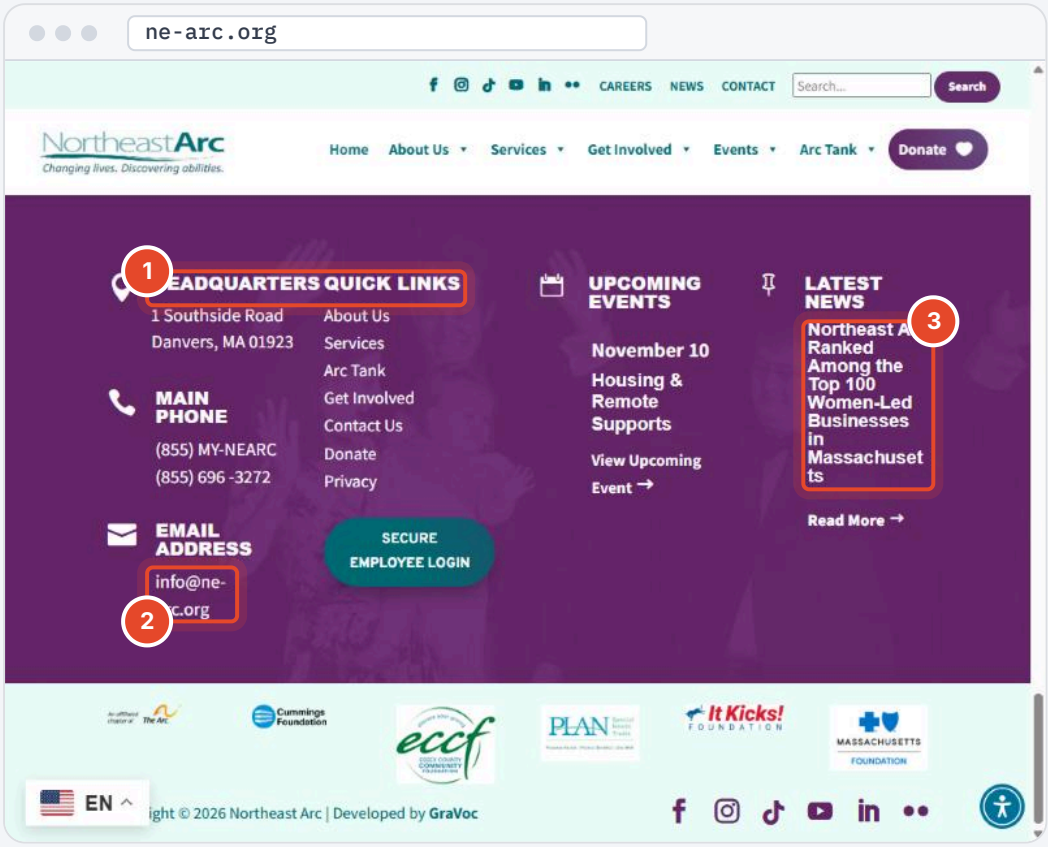
-30 to 40%
mobile page length

Higher
scroll depth to contact and Donate

Finding 07

Medium | Footer | Effort: S

Footer headings collide and text breaks mid word



"HEADQUARTERS QUICK LINKS" run together; "Massachuset ts" and "info@ne-arc.org" break

Why it costs you

Small layout faults in the footer, where people look for contact details, chip away at the organisation's credibility.

What we found

- The Headquarters and Quick Links headings touch, **reading as one heading**.
- Narrow columns break "Massachusetts" and the email address across lines.
- The upcoming event link reads "View Upcoming Event $" **with a stray dollar sign**.

Recommendation

→ Use a **4 column grid with fixed gutters**; let long words wrap normally and keep the email on one line.

→ Fix the event link label.

Expected impact if fixed

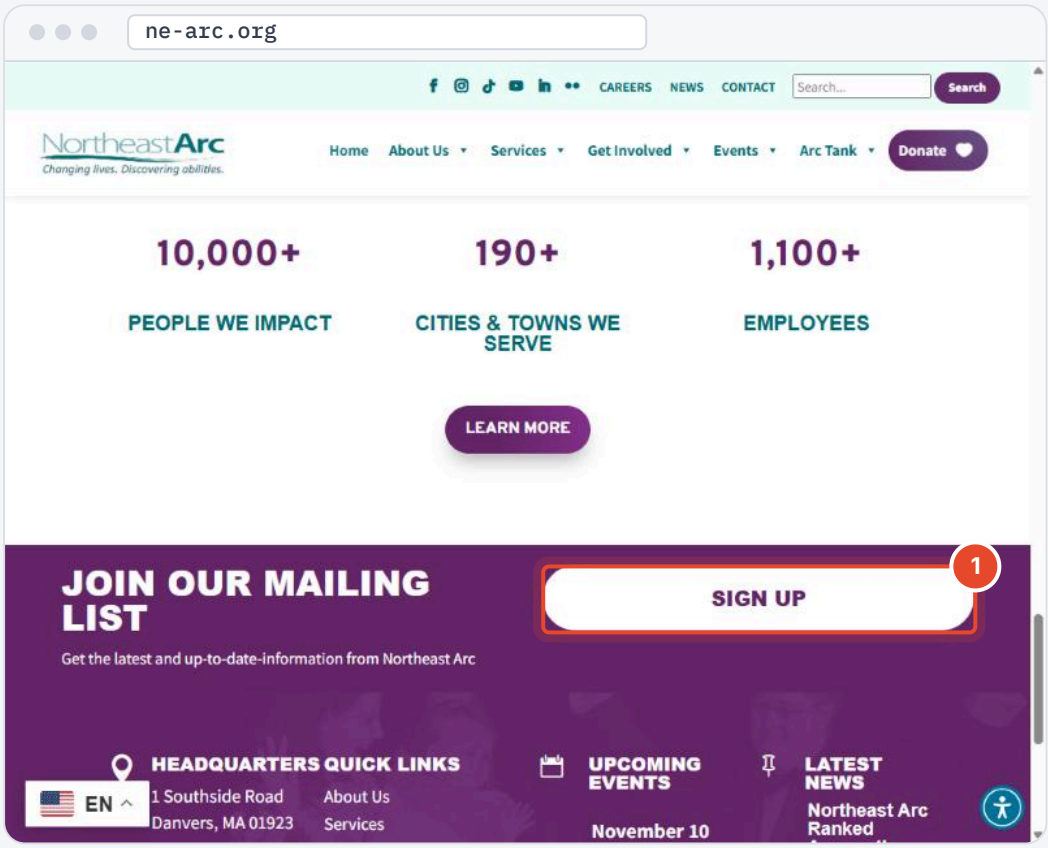
Better
perceived quality and trust

Easier
contact lookup

Finding 08

Medium | Retention | Effort: S

"Join our mailing list" sends people to another page instead of capturing the email



The Sign up button links to the Get Involved page

Why it costs you

Every extra click loses subscribers. The mailing list is the cheapest channel for donations, events and parcels promotions.

What we found

- The large Sign up button opens /get-involved/ **rather than showing an email field**.
- **Impact numbers differ across properties**: 10,000+ people and 190+ towns here, 12,000 people and nearly 200 communities on parcelsgifts.com.

Recommendation

→ Put an **email field and button directly in the band**; offer interests (Donor news, Family resources, parcels gifts).

→ Align impact numbers across ne-arc.org and parcelsgifts.com.

Expected impact if fixed

+30 to 50%
mailing list signups

Consistent
impact story across sites

Finding 09

High | Performance and access | Effort: M

A heavy homepage, and inner pages that refused our test browser

Why it costs you

Slow pages lose mobile visitors, and an over strict security rule can silently block donors and families, particularly on shared networks, VPNs or privacy browsers.

What we found

- The homepage made **193 requests and transferred about 14 MB**, with 156 script tags; full load took about 3.3 seconds on a fast connection.
- After the homepage loaded, every inner page we opened in our test browser (About, Services, Donate) **returned "403 Forbidden"** from the server.
- The same pages loaded when fetched by a different client, which suggests a firewall or bot rule that **may also block some real visitors**.

Recommendation

→ **Audit plugins and scripts** (events, Instagram, sliders, translation) and remove what is not used on the homepage.

→ Serve images as WebP at display size; enable caching and a CDN.

→ **Ask the hosting provider to review WAF and rate limit rules** and check server logs for legitimate visitors receiving 403 errors.

Expected impact if fixed

-50 to 70%
homepage page weight

Recovered
visitors currently blocked by 403 errors

04 · Business impact

What these fixes are worth

Ranges are based on nonprofit and e-commerce benchmarks and our experience. They are directional; validate with Google Analytics and your donation platform reports.

Metric	Driven by	Expected change	How to measure
Mobile visits to Donate	Finding 01	**+40 to 80%**	GA4: page views of the donation page from mobile
Donation form completion	Finding 04	**+10 to 25%**	GiveWP: completed / form views
Average online gift	Finding 04	**+15 to 20%**	GiveWP reports
Intake enquiries	Finding 05	**+15 to 30%**	Referral emails, calls and form submissions
Referral visits to parcels	Finding 03	**2 to 3x**	Square: sessions referred by ne-arc.org (UTM tagged)
Mailing list signups	Finding 08	**+30 to 50%**	New contacts per month
Homepage weight	Finding 09	**-50 to 70%**	PageSpeed Insights, mobile

Illustrative: parcels referrals today

200 / month

Visitors sent to parcels	**200**
Store conversion	**0.6%**
Orders	**1.2**
Revenue at $32	**$38**

With a homepage shop band

600 / month

Visitors sent to parcels	**600**
Store conversion (after store fixes)	**1.0%**
Orders	**6**
Revenue at $40	**$240**

Illustrative model with assumed traffic, not Northeast Arc data. Supporters arriving from ne-arc.org are mission aware, so they usually convert better than average shop visitors; this model is deliberately conservative. Tag all parcels links with UTM parameters to measure the real effect.

05 · Roadmap

A 90 day plan, quick wins first

Sequenced so the cheapest, highest impact fixes ship in the first two weeks and pay for the rest.

Weeks 1 to 2

Quick wins

01 Visible Donate button in the mobile header

02 Shop parcels in the main menu, UTM tagged

03 Inline mailing list field

04 Footer fixes and one Donate destination

05 Hosting review of 403 / WAF rules

Weeks 3 to 6

Clear paths

06 Static hero with Get support, Donate, Shop parcels

07 "Shop with purpose" homepage band

08 Donation page story and impact tiers

09 Script and image clean up

Weeks 7 to 12

Deeper journeys

10 "Find support for..." selector and call back form

11 Rebuilt services grid and mobile layout

12 Monthly giving program and donor thank you journey

13 Shared impact numbers across both sites

06 · Method

How this audit was done

Scope and setup

- Live review on November 4, 2026 of the homepage on desktop (1024 × 768) and mobile emulation (375 × 812) in Chromium.
- The Donate and parcels pages were reviewed from their page source, because the test browser received 403 errors on inner pages.

Frameworks

- Nielsen's 10 usability heuristics and a nonprofit donation journey checklist.
- WCAG 2.2 spot checks (heading structure, duplicated content, tap targets).
- Page weight and timing from the browser Performance API.

Scoring

- Each area scored 0 to 100 against the checklist; the overall score is the average.
- Severity: Critical blocks a primary goal (donating, getting support), High measurably reduces it, Medium and Low affect trust and polish.

Limitations

- No access to analytics or donation data, so impact ranges are estimates.
- Interior service pages could not be inspected visually; a follow up review is recommended once access rules are confirmed.